18.5 Major Depressive Disorder

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "Nothing will ever get better." • "I am a burden." **Objective** • Flat affect, speaks slowly • Withdrawn, stays in bed • Hardly makes eye contact	**ACTUAL** **Hopelessness** related to depressive illness as evidenced by negative statements about the future and withdrawal.	Within 1 week, names one thing she hopes for in the future.	• Assess her mood and her suicide risk on admission and regularly after that. • Spend short periods with her, often. • Encourage small activities she can manage. • Give antidepressants as prescribed and watch how they work. • Refer for psychotherapy.	Names a goal: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I do not feel like eating or washing." **Objective** • Lost 4 kg • Not washing	**ACTUAL** **Self-neglect** related to low mood and lack of energy as evidenced by poor hygiene and reduced intake.	Washes every day and eats at least half of each meal.	• Set up a simple daily routine. • Offer small meals and foods she likes. • Help and encourage her to wash, without doing it all for her.	Looking after herself better: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Sometimes I wish I would not wake up." **Objective** • Feels hopeless • Cut off from others	**RISK** **Risk for suicidal behavior** as evidenced by risk factors: depression, hopelessness and expressed wish to die.	Stays safe and tells staff when the thoughts get stronger.	• Ask her directly about suicidal thoughts and plans. • Remove dangerous items as policy says. • Observe her at the level ordered. • Agree with her how she will ask for help.	Safe: **goal met**.